

Chapter 1: Introduction

National Transportation Planning Factors

Since the Intermodal Surface Transportation Efficiency Act of 1991 (ISTEA), Congress has identified key planning areas for MPOs and states to consider when developing multimodal transportation plans. MAP-21 established ten planning factors under 23 CFR 450.306 that remain in effect through the FAST Act and IIJA:

- Support the **economic vitality** of the metropolitan area, especially by enabling global competitiveness, productivity, and efficiency
- Increase the **safety** of the transportation system for motorized and non-motorized users
- Increase the **security** of the transportation system for motorized and non-motorized users
- Increase the **accessibility and mobility** of people and freight
- Protect and enhance the **environment**, promote energy conservation, improve quality of life, and promote consistency between transportation improvements and planned growth and economic development
- Enhance the **integration and connectivity** of the transportation system across and between modes for people and freight
- Promote efficient **system management and operation**
- Emphasize the **preservation** of the existing transportation system
- Improve the **resiliency and reliability** of the transportation system and reduce or mitigate stormwater impacts of surface transportation
- Enhance **travel and tourism**

